



SUCCESS SKILL: CREATIVITY

BACKGROUND

This rubric is aligned to the NCIEA's [literature review](#) on creativity. The value proposition is a clear research-based definition of creativity as a success skill. This research-based rubric¹ is designed to provide useful, formative information that teachers can use to guide instruction and provide feedback to students. Students can use it to reflect on their creative thinking processes and products. Student performance is described along a continuum and balances products (solutions, ideas) and creative processes. Rubrics are provided by grade span, K-2, 3-5, and 6-12. The K-2 rubric includes both a teacher version and a version for primary students or early readers. Highlights from the National Center for Assessment's Literature Review are provided below.

"Creativity is the interaction among aptitude, process, and environment by which an individual or group produces a perceptible product that is both novel and useful as defined within a social context," (Plucker et al, p. 90).

Creativity may vary across content areas or domains, often depending on more general skills and abilities such as divergent and convergent thinking, synthesizing ideas, or experimentation. These abilities influence the creative process regardless of domain; as expertise develops, so does creativity. Meaning, a person can be a creative genius in music but not in mathematics (Brandt, 2021).

SUPPORT CREATIVITY USING GOLD STANDARD PBL

To support creativity in the context of Gold Standard PBL, consider intentional teaching practices and structures that enhance creativity (Brandt, 2021; Davies et al., 2013).

- **Support student voice and choice.** In Gold Standard PBL, [student voice & choice](#) is one of the seven essential design elements. Projects should allow students to make their voices heard, and to make choices about what they investigate, the products they create, and how they work and use time, guided by the teacher as appropriate. "Teachers can prioritize creativity by listening to students' interests, affirming their strengths and talents, incorporating students' unique interests in performance tasks, and modeling intrinsic enjoyment of creative pursuits." (Brandt, 2021, p. 16).
- **Build student agency.** Shared power is one of the [4 equity levers in Project Based Learning](#). Shared power calls for teachers to shift their instructional approach to a collaborative, learner-center model to redistribute power in the classroom to students.
- **Incorporate problem-solving.** Students should have frequent low-stakes opportunities to generate and experiment with ideas. Projects that support creative development include challenging and open-ended problems or [driving questions](#) with no single solution and include time and space for brainstorming, iteration, revision, and reflection.
- **Plan for collaboration.** Projects should include opportunities for both peer collaboration and collaborative partnerships with adults or outside agencies. One example is group problem-solving or brainstorming supports the generation of new ideas, which is part of the creative process. Research indicates there is a strong relationship between creativity and collaboration.
- **Reinforce intrinsic motivation.** Intrinsic motivation can be reinforced and nurtured through the knowledge of students, a PBL equity lever, and intentional opportunities for voice and choice. Creativity is also supported through the use of team structures in the classroom, rather than competitive structures and external rewards which can inhibit creativity (Brandt, 2021).
- **Focus on formative feedback.** Narrative feedback that is formative in nature, rather than summative or evaluative, supports the development of creative processes. Classroom assessments should focus on the formative aspects of creativity

¹ These rubrics were created by National Center for Improvement of Educational Assessment (Center for Assessment) in collaboration with PBLWorks. This version of the rubric integrates asset-based language based on the *Ready for Rigor: A Framework for Culturally Responsive Teaching* (Hammond, 2013).



Creativity: Grade 3-5

Creativity is a process through which an individual or group produces something that is both novel and useful.²

	Creativity			
	<i>Select the column where most of the criteria describe the creative products developed and the processes used.</i>			
	BEGINNING	EMERGING	DEVELOPING	DEMONSTRATING
Creative Product (Products, Ideas, Solutions)				
Novelty and Usefulness	Product copies an example.	Product reflects a copied example with a few additional features.	Product reflects a novel or useful idea/solution to the problem/task objectives.	Product reflects both a novel and useful idea/solution to the problem/task objectives.
Creative Thinking Process				
Generating and Experimenting	Generates ideas that are disconnected from the problem/task objectives.	Generates a limited number of ideas. Recognizes when ideas connect to the problem/task objectives when those ideas are presented by others.	Generates a limited number of ideas that directly connect to the problem/task objectives. Investigates ideas and possibilities from more than one perspective.	Generates a range of ideas that directly connect to the problem/task objectives. Investigates ideas and possibilities from multiple perspectives.
Selecting and Elaborating	Explanation of the product is disconnected from the problem/task objectives.	Explanation of the product demonstrates an emerging understanding of the problem/task objectives. Certain actions or responses may be disconnected from the problem/task objectives.	Explanation of the product demonstrates an understanding of the problem/task objectives.	Explanation of the product demonstrates a detailed understanding of the problem/task objectives. Explanation is clear, detailed, and convincing.

² In this rubric, “product” refers to products, ideas and solutions developed to address a pre-determined problem and/or set of task objectives.